

CEO Letter from Maziar Minovi | Q3 2026

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【メール原文】

This is a quarterly letter from Maziar Minovi, the CEO of Eurasia Group, the world's leading geopolitical research and advisory firm. Each quarter, Maziar provides a window into the analysis, offerings, and developments that allow our clients to get the most out of their partnership with Eurasia Group and GZERO Media.

"the ai revolution is coming for the hedgehog and the fox. be honest about which one you are. if you're a hedgehog, ai is coming for the narrow expertise that made you valuable (and you better have strong/unique human networks that differentiate you). if you're a fox, ai is a research assistant that makes you faster at the one thing no model has an incentive to do: connect dots across domains."

– Ian Bremmer

Hi all,

Is AI a bubble? Will AI displace workers faster than it creates jobs? Will AI turbocharge political polarization even more than the internet already has? Can regulation effectively contain the use of AI for cyberattacks, biological weapons development, and deepfakes? How will the US-China rivalry influence AI development and regulation? Can Europe hope to compete at the AI frontier? How should middle powers and the Global South position themselves to not be left behind in the AI race? How do we build trust in the age of AI? How will the politics of data center construction affect the US midterm elections?

Sitting at the crossroads of technology, politics, and economics, Eurasia Group professionals partner with our clients every day to address such questions. We were early in this space by starting to build out our Geo-technology practice in 2016 to understand issues at the intersection of technology and geopolitics. AI is the most important innovation since then and poses incredible opportunities as well as potential threats across all sectors, and everyone is exposed.

The upside is hard to miss, whether that's monitoring rainforest usage and deforestation in Brazil , machine-learning flood models that improve forecast lead times and response rates , recovery of cultural heritage , or medical breakthroughs, including global accessibility for tuberculosis screening and prevention of diabetes-related blindness in India and Thailand .

The upside has also clearly been noticed by investors, as inflows have driven a record-breaking equity boom in US stocks despite major headwinds, including rising interest rates and a global trade war. Our Geoeconomics team examined this AI market boom and compared it to other revolutions in their recent Top Calls report .

Along with AI's potential, however, Eurasia Group is also mindful of the hazards. Domestic and international governance and oversight are falling further behind the multitrillion-dollar investments fueling the headlong rush to build AI's foundations: power, chips, and digital skills.

We have highlighted the key risks from the widening gap between technological advancement and regulation of AI in our flagship Top Risks report each of the past four years: Weapons of Mass Disruption (2023), Ungoverned AI (2024), AI unbound (2025), and AI eats its users (2026). In this year's report, we highlighted that AI can't live up to investors' expectations in the short term. Under pressure to

generate revenue and unconstrained by guardrails, leading AI companies will adopt business models that threaten social and political stability—following social media's destructive playbook, only faster and at greater scale.

As our clients know, our analysis doesn't shy away from the hard questions. Here are just a few of those our research teams have addressed in recent months:

- * Can regulation effectively contain AI's use for cyberattacks, biological proliferation, and deepfakes?
- * US water sector will remain vulnerable to cyberattacks , 19 August
- * eg update, Heather West , 24 August
- * Geopolitical competition will fracture global efforts to tackle AI risks , 25 August
- * Can Europe hope to compete at the AI frontier?
- * AI dependency draws Europe toward Washington despite tech sovereignty push , 1 July
- * How should middle powers and the Global South position themselves to not be left behind in the AI race?
- * Middle powers will resist becoming permanent importers of AI , 12 May
- * How will the politics of data center construction affect the US midterm elections?
- * Four regulatory camps emerge as states move toward restricting data centers , 30 July 2026

And of course, Ian has been at the forefront of thinking about the implications of AI and how we should mitigate their most disruptive risks. To that end, he serves as a member of the United Nations' High-level Advisory Body on Artificial Intelligence and has written about and discussed his views on these issues at length, including his recent deep dives into where the geopolitics of AI is heading (eg update , 27 July) and AI governance (eg update , 13 July). So, how should executives actually deploy these AI tools in the meantime? Marc Gustafson, managing director of analysis, has a few things to say about that too (Why CEOs need their own situation rooms , 1 June).

But what about whether AI will replace workers faster than it creates jobs? There are companies that are starting to see a return on their AI investment, but the workforce transformation is in its early stages. Right now, success is best measured in terms of productivity, whereas the technology's impact on profitability is less clear. Indeed, some companies are citing AI as a reason for layoffs, but hard evidence of its impact on the bottom line remains scarce (The AI jobs backlash is arriving before broad job losses , 8 September).

Our new Geo-technology practice head can shed some light on the conversations she is having with clients and partners about these issues.

View from: Heather West, practice head, Geo-technology

From our DC office, I work with colleagues who cover every region, market, and risk on the map. Technology and AI run through all of that work, and that of our clients across sectors.

The question clients keep asking us is whether AI will take jobs. I think the more useful version is who will be hired, who will be kept, and how the work itself will change.

Here's how we see it right now. AI is changing who companies hire before it changes how many. Three years into enterprise adoption, we don't see substantial displacement in the aggregate data, and we don't expect it over the next year.

Where firms are adjusting, it's through hiring freezes rather than firing, since a freeze is easy to reverse and a layoff isn't. Where we do expect pressure is on mid-career roles, where the work is mostly throughput, and judgment isn't yet the main part of the job. Judgment is the piece AI can't really do.

Meanwhile, the political and popular conversation is outrunning the evidence. Four in five Americans expect AI to take jobs, and legislators in both parties talk about displacement as if it were established. Over the next few years, how people perceive AI's effect on work will matter about as much as the actual changes.

That's part of why using AI and using AI well are two different things. There's a lot of experimentation happening, which is healthy, but experimenting isn't adopting, and adopting isn't necessarily conferring advantage. Knowing which questions to ask and recognizing when the answer on the screen isn't what you need are roles for people—not AI models.

That's the job: helping you ask, and answer, the right questions.

The million-dollar question is whether AI changes the relative value of/premium commanded by foxes (generalists) vs hedgehogs (specialists), and if so, what does that mean for Eurasia Group analysts?

As a company with its fair share of subject matter experts, Eurasia Group is using AI to streamline operational tasks and things that are necessary but not core to our business. We're using the time this frees up to strengthen what sets us apart—like our robust human networks. When it comes to analysis and advisory work, we use AI as a thought partner alongside our colleagues—an aid and provocateur, not a replacement.

In the spirit of asking better questions, we encourage employees to experiment with AI to enhance their workflow. For our research teams, this means automated conference call notes, standardized decks, assistance with timesheets, and added insight to inform our analysis. These tools are designed to help analysts do what they do best: apply judgment and assess what happens next, rather than rely on AI to answer questions.

Our AI enablement team is setting up ad hoc monitors and sentiment trackers for emerging crises—for example, compiling satellite data on ship traffic in the Strait of Hormuz so analysts can quickly get an overview and respond faster to breaking developments. Noah Daponte-Smith (senior analyst, United States) is using AI to aggregate and screen public opinion polling to build a poll average that will provide additional insight into the upcoming Israeli and French elections. Allie Korbey (analyst, Consumer & Retail) is building a dynamic dashboard that consolidates, organizes, and tracks key news and Eurasia Group notes relevant to each client's core issue areas—streamlining and deepening client engagement.

I asked Allie to explain the role she sees AI playing in her day-to-day work:

Allie Korbey, senior analyst, Consumer & Retail

Some tasks are high-friction because they demand deep thinking; others are high-friction because they're cumbersome, not cognitively demanding. It's not a perfect framework, but I'm trying to build

the habit of reaching for AI specifically for that second bucket (e.g., scattered information, repetitive daily tasks, or messy, unorganized data). Building the muscle, while not relying on it, allows me to keep doing the deeper work myself while trying to move faster all around.

Just as Allie laid out, our value-add for clients isn't necessarily compiling the information but rather making sense of it.

Jon Lieber (head of research) says he's noticed the biggest improvements in speed and quality across our research products, including notes and conference calls, which are now clearer and easier to digest. Analysts also have more time for higher-value work that can be done only by humans, such as applying judgment and experience to make sense of data, building policymaker networks, mentoring junior colleagues, and connecting face-to-face with clients.

Connecting our global network of executives, thought leaders, and policymakers

The breadth and depth of our network have always been a key strength for Eurasia Group. While AI tools may escape containment and hack Hugging Face, they cannot nurture, learn from, and connect our global network and clients.

We see our relationship with clients as a two-way street. The best relationships are those in which we learn from each other. In July, we had Tom Key (Mubadala Investments), who previously established BCG's Executive Placement Services and The Bain Executive Network [BEN], stop by our NYC office to lead a workshop on networking for virtual and in-person audiences.

Tom emphasized that there are a lot of unknowns when it comes to AI, including where the technology is headed and what it will mean for our careers, our day-to-day lives, and for future generations. But what we do know is that conversations and personal connections aren't going anywhere; if anything, they will be more valuable than ever before.

Fourth US-Canada Summit

We view our events as the ideal opportunity to convene our network, foster meaningful dialogues, and enjoy programming about the pressing issues of the day.

On 11 June, we hosted our fourth US-Canada Summit, and our first as part of our new strategic partnership with Royal Bank of Canada (RBC), Canada's largest corporation and most important financial institution. It's safe to say that we've set a high bar for these events, and this year's summit was no exception.

Attendees heard from ambassadors Pete Hoekstra and Mark Wiseman and ministers Dominic LeBlanc, Melanie Joly, and Evan Solomon, as well as Pennsylvania Governor Josh Shapiro and former US trade representative Robert Lighthizer. Our speakers and panelists covered key issues including food systems and supply chains, economic cooperation, infrastructure, and the Arctic. Recent events have borne out our longstanding view that the US-Canada relationship remains central to geopolitics.

Lighthizer (18th US trade representative) and Gerald Butts (chairman, Eurasia Group)

To quote what an attendee told Scott Young (director, strategic initiatives):

"The difference between a Eurasia Group event and other events is that I just saw four speakers in a row who, anywhere else, would headline any other conference."

This week, we co-hosted a series of closed-door events in partnership with RBC on the sidelines of Canadian prime minister Mark Carney's inaugural Canada Investment Summit in Toronto.

Eurasia Group's strategic counselor, Dominic Barton, and RBC CEO, Dave McKay, co-hosted a VIP roundtable on Monday, bringing together a select group of international investors and major Canadian CEOs for a no-holds-barred conversation on where Canada stands and where Canada is going globally. We followed that with an evening reception for international summit attendees, Eurasia Group and RBC clients, and other friends of the firm.

All in all, Canada remains a central part of our growth – and we look forward to continued partnership with Dave and his team in the lead-up to our 2027 US-Canada Summit next spring.

GZERO Summit Asia is purpose-built for the Indo-Pacific moment

I was just on the other side of the world in Singapore on 10 September to kick off our inaugural GZERO Summit Asia. It was purpose-built for the Indo-Pacific moment, as middle powers grapple with opportunities for growth in an increasingly G-ZERO world.

Singapore is a hub where regional dynamics and global spillovers intersect, making it the ideal place to discuss issues such as trade and supply chains, the energy transition, and how Asian countries can scale their AI infrastructure. It provides a unique vantage point for connecting US-China competition, Middle East spillovers, Europe's de-risking, and global elections into a single integrated view for Asia-based leadership. Unlike broader business conferences, our Asia Summit was thoughtful and candid, giving leaders from throughout the region the opportunity to grapple with how local and global geopolitical dynamics are affecting their bottom line.

Moving beyond the headlines of the day, speakers on the main stage included Dilhan Pillay Sandrasegara (CEO, Temasek Holdings), Irving Tan (CEO, WD), and Josephine Teo (Minister for Digital Development and Information). Participants in closed-door roundtables discussed practical means of addressing some of the region's most pressing challenges including evolving trade and security alliances, gaps in human and financial resources that are hindering AI diffusion, and the need to deepen investments across the continent.

To deepen our impact in the region, on 15 October, we will host a series of breakout roundtables in Bangkok during the IMF and World Bank Group Annual Meetings, focused on how the current geopolitical state of play is affecting emerging markets. These roundtables will feature off-the-record briefings with global policymakers and thought leaders, similar to those we have hosted in Washington, DC, during the Spring Meetings.

If you're interested in joining us in Bangkok, drop me a line.

If that's not in your neck of the woods, we'll also have GZERO Summits in London (8 October) and Tokyo (8 December), as well as programming in New York City during the UN General Assembly in September.

Our media arm, GZERO, and Microsoft will bring together delegates, officials, and business leaders at the Global Stage Cafe during UNGA High-level Week

During the 81st United Nations General Assembly High-level Week, GZERO and Microsoft will create the Global Stage Cafe, a full-day destination where delegates, officials, business leaders, and partners can gather between commitments, follow key UNGA moments, and engage with Global Stage programming on AI diffusion, trust, security, resilience, and geopolitics and technology.

GZERO takes the mainstage during the AI for Good Summit

Earlier this summer, GZERO returned to the AI for Good Global Summit in Geneva for a second year as a media partner, strengthening its relationship with the International Telecommunication Union. Tony Maciulis (managing director, Eurasia Group and head of content, GZERO) hosted a Global Stage livestream discussion on how AI can help address humanitarian challenges such as disaster preparedness and climate resilience. Panelists included Microsoft Vice Chair and President Brad Smith, UN General Assembly President Annalena Baerbock, UN Special Envoy for Digital and Emerging Technologies Amandeep Singh Gill, and others.

So, we're leaning into what differentiates us. Our people. And what better place to start than the beginning:

Intern season: What the next generation thinks about AI, algorithms, and working in an office

This year, we somehow managed to make our intern program even more competitive. We received more than double the number of applications we did last summer, driving down our acceptance rate from 0.4% in 2025 to 0.2% in 2026. Learn more about who made the cut [here](#) and [here](#).

So, how did they spend their time? Our Geo-technology intern, Amelia Frank, worked with our AI enablement team to develop an AI tool that categorized fourteen years' worth of Eurasia Group's analysis, creating an automated call tracker that measures the accuracy of our analysis and identifies common patterns and analytical errors.

In addition to their day-to-day work, the interns delivered group research presentations at the end of their tenure on pressing issues of the day. This year's topics: US foreign policy after President Donald Trump, global semiconductor supply chains, and the impact of the Iran war on the AI landscape in the Gulf.

Marc Gustafson (managing director of analysis) hosted a dinner for our DC-based interns alongside summer interns from other DC-based organizations. I always say that we learn as much from our interns as they learn from us.

Marc and Gerard DiPippo (director, Global Macro) hosted a dinner with Eurasia Group and other DC summer interns

Unsurprisingly, AI was a hot topic in our conversations with the next generation. Several points stood out:

- * Their range of capabilities and awareness of AI were very uneven—some had limited exposure to the technology, while others were deeply immersed in it.
- * We had lively debates about AI rights, whether AI has feelings, and AI sentience.
- * Everyone in this cohort expressed a desire for human connections with people from different backgrounds. They described how they felt they had grown up after the era of monoculture; algorithms—a word that came up repeatedly—catered to their micro-interests, fracturing a collective sense of cultural identity.
- * Many feel an impulse to return to past practices and seek more connections away from the virtual world.
- * None of them wanted to work from home. They are eager to be with people.
- * They are optimistic about the future, even though everyone keeps telling them that bad things are trending.

Pulse Survey

In the age of AI, what skill do you think will be most important for the generation that's starting their careers right now?

Building a network

Critical thinking

Emotional intelligence

Judgment

All of the above

AI can fake some of these things, though not well.

Partnering with AI is a strategy that we believe will pay off. At the end of the day, AI cannot replace our human experts. But it can deepen our insights by making analysts more productive and focused on using their own judgment, expertise, contacts, and networks. That support helps us provide the tools and understanding clients need in a world where politics drives disruption—which, not incidentally, is our mission .

Best,

Maziar

New Talent

Heather West : Heather brings twenty years of experience across the private sector, civil society, and technology industry. She has spent her career translating between the people who build technology and the people who need to understand it. At Eurasia Group, she advises clients on the political and regulatory risks shaping the technology landscape, with a focus on AI, cybersecurity, data regulation, digital infrastructure, competition, sovereignty, and global regulatory strategy.

Alexander Kolyandr : Alexander began his career as a journalist covering business, commodities, and macroeconomics, and later transitioned into financial markets and political risk analysis. He worked for several years in Moscow and London as a strategist and senior economist focused on Russia, the Commonwealth of Independent States, and emerging-market geopolitics. His background in economics and politics positions him to provide our clients with a nuanced, holistic understanding of the Eurasia region and the Russia-Ukraine war.

Ben Reeves : Ben is a communications leader and narrative strategist serving as Eurasia Group's new head of communications. He previously served as director of CEO communications for the chief executive of Dow Jones and publisher of The Wall Street Journal and as director of speechwriting for New York Governor Kathy Hochul. Ben began his career in journalism, reporting from four continents for publications including the New York Times, USA Today, and the Los Angeles Review of Books. He also held several editorial roles at Worth magazine.

Chris Loewald : Chris brings senior central bank and fiscal policy expertise to Eurasia Group's South Africa coverage. As the former chief economist and head of economic research at the South African Reserve Bank (SARB), Chris was a voting member of the Monetary Policy Committee and led economic research, forecasting, and global economic analysis. Before joining the SARB, he spent 13 years at the South African National Treasury in senior policy roles. His deep experience in monetary policy, macroeconomic analysis, fiscal strategy, and international economic policy will be an asset to our clients and partners.

New and improved client portal provides intuitive access

Over the past couple of years, we've collaborated with many of you on how we can tailor our digital experience to better meet your needs. After months of development, we officially flipped the switch: The new Eurasia Group portal is now live.

We hope this new experience provides more intuitive access to our insights and our analysts. If you have any questions, please reach out to support@eurasiagroup.net.

Recommended Reads + Listens

Atlas of Impunity

On 29 June, Eurasia Group and an expert advisory board launched the fourth edition of The Atlas of Impunity, one of the most comprehensive global measures of abuse of power and accountability.

This year's report finds the gap between the most accountable and most impunity-prone countries has widened to a record level, with declining press freedom emerging as a central driver.

Press Coverage

- * What Now? With Trevor Noah: Who Is Actually Running the World? (Ian) (23 April)
- * I've Got Questions with Sinead Bovell: How AI is Creating a New World Order (Ian) (5 May)
- * The Most Interesting Thing in AI with Nicholas Thompson: How AI Could Throw the Global Order Into Chaos (Ian) (19 August)
- * Foreign Affairs: Why China Waits (Amanda Hsiao) (8 May)
- * LSEG Sustainable Growth: The water weapon: How governance gaps are shaping risk (Franck Gbaguidi) (26 May)
- * CNBC: China's exports are 'indispensable' to global economy (Dan Wang) (16 June)
- * Foreign Affairs: The Long Shadow of the Iran War (Ian and Firas Maksad) (17 June)

GZERO

- * GZERO Graphic Truth: A world still divided on LGBTQ rights
- * GZERO World: Can Hezbollah really be disarmed? With Kim Ghattas
- * Puppet Regime: Trump asks for Putin's help in Iran
- * The Debrief with Mij Rahman: Has Andy Burnham killed the UK's far right?
- * GZERO Analysis: Progressives are rising, but Black voters aren't sold

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